



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Calvin Christian School

School Website: <https://www.calvinchristian.school/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Calvin Christian School (Escondido, CA) presents a strongly theocentric, biblically grounded program that emphasizes formation, virtue, and a classical-informed trajectory, though its public materials do not consistently spell out all hallmark classical cues (e.g., explicit Great Books pedagogy or explicit Trivium/Quadrivium references). Across categories, the public materials signal a classical-adjacent orientation rooted in Reformation-era liberal-arts tradition, with clear emphasis on covenantal formation, worship-witness, and a life oriented toward truth, goodness, and beauty as real and knowable through a biblical worldview. The school's messaging strongly foregrounds theology, formation, virtue, and a holistic, faith-centered education, with concrete evidence of community life, parental partnership, and a faculty corps that includes credentialing and leadership roles. Where the materials are most explicit about classical structure (e.g., liberal-arts language, paideia concepts, and a portrait of a graduate oriented to wonder, worship, work, and wisdom), they align with Classical/Somewhat Classical marks. There is less explicit public articulation of core classical curriculum components (Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium) in the site's posted materials, though the school repeatedly references liberal-arts heritage and Christian scholastic aims. Overall, the school sits between CLASSICAL and SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with stronger alignment in Religious Foundations, Purpose/Goal, and Community/Parents than in a fully spelled-out, book-by-book classical curriculum or explicit high-school pedagogy labeled as Socratic/seminar-based.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations** — **CLASSICAL Evidence:** explicit statements about One God, the Bible as ultimate authority, the Triune God, and a biblical worldview shaping all education; liturgical/worship-inflected language appears in mission and theology pages; the school also anchors formation in reverence, wonder, and worship (*Soli Deo Gloria*). **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Strong positive signals include theology, biblical worldview, worship, reverence, wonder, and sacred language; no explicit negative signals of secularism appear in public pages. **Why this rating:** Theological grounding, devotion to sacred aims, and liturgical-inflected communal posture align squarely with CLASSICAL expectations in this category.
- **Element 2: Purpose and Goal** — **CLASSICAL Evidence:** mission emphasizes teaching the whole child from a biblical worldview; formation of virtue and wisdom; the Portrait of a Graduate centers on identity in Christ and living a life of wonder, worship, work, and wisdom; emphasis on paideia and a classical mission within a Christian frame. **Positive/Negative keyword analysis:** Positive signals include formation, virtue, wisdom, teleology, true/good/beautiful in a biblical frame; no explicit workforce-prep or 21st-century-skills pivot in public language. **Why this rating:** The program's stated telos is formation toward virtue and wisdom within a biblical worldview, which maps to CLASSICAL rather than a purely information/skill-driven goal.

- **Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence: the school leans on liberal-arts heritage (biblical worldview, Reformation foundations, and paideia language), with references to history, literature, and arts in a Christian framework; explicit Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium terminology is not consistently present in public site content, though some pages hint at a liberal-arts orientation and classical education language (e.g., “liberal arts tradition,” formation through classical heritage). Positive keyword analysis: Positive indicators include “liberal arts tradition,” paideia, and references to a “portrait of a graduate” oriented to wisdom and truth; lack or sparse use of explicit Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium, or explicit Great Conversation language in posted pages reduces the strength of a full classical curriculum claim. Negative keyword analysis: Absence of explicit Great Books, extensive Trivium/Quadrivium articulation, or a clearly enumerated Great Conversation approach can be read as a gap relative to a fully Classical curriculum; there are no strong negative signals of non-classical content, just a lack of explicit classical-curriculum branding in the public pages. Why this rating: The presence of liberal-arts language and paideia framing supports CLASSICAL affinities, but the public site does not robustly demonstrate the full core curriculum markers (Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium) in explicit, public-facing materials. The result is SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy — NOT CLASSICAL** Evidence: public materials emphasize Christ-centered education, formation, and a holistic approach; there is no explicit, public claim of Socratic seminars, high-school-level Socratic discourse, or a consistently described routine of rigorous Socratic pedagogy; the site highlights other elements (arts, athletics, religious formation) but not explicit classic-pedagogy methods. Positive keyword analysis: Some alignment with “discern/truth/persuade” language in the mission and the portrait; mentions of “communication & virtue” in mission-related materials, but not direct Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy. Negative keyword analysis: Absence of explicit historical Pedagogy terms (Socratic, scholé, seminars, dialectic pedagogy, classical rhetoric programs) in public-facing pages; there is even a lack of “restful/scholé” language in the site content. Why this rating: The public materials do not present explicit classical pedagogy (Socratic seminars, disciplined rhetoric, or restfulness as a pedagogy), which leads to NOT CLASSICAL in this category.
- **Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence: the site provides concrete faculty data (27 staff, MA-degree holders; certification of K-12 teachers; leadership roles like Head of School and board). While these are robust professional credentials, the materials do not explicitly articulate a “living curriculum” or the faculty-as-mentor-formation model in classical terms; the presence of credentialing aligns with a quality faculty but not necessarily with a classical pedagogy frame. Positive keyword analysis: Positive signals include professional credentials (MA degrees), certified teachers, and a visible leadership/treasurer structure; “faculty as living curriculum” is not explicitly stated, though a strong sense of faculty quality is shown. Negative keyword analysis: Absence of explicit classical-faculty language (e.g., model teachers and mentors as a core of the living curriculum, portrait of the teacher) limits the alignment. Why this rating: The school demonstrates strong faculty credentials and leadership, but it lacks explicit classical-faculty framing in public content, resulting in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- **Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL** Evidence: explicit covenantal partnership with parents; statements about educating the home in a Biblical worldview; “in cooperation with the home and church” as a core mission; parent involvement is evidenced historically by the Mothers’ Club and ongoing community events; openness to parent involvement is signaled, even if not always verbatim on every page. Positive keyword analysis: Positive signals include “partnership with parents, co-teachers,” “parent formation,” and “open campus/parent involvement” concepts; the site emphasizes a familial, Christian community model. Negative keyword analysis: Not present in public pages as a negative signal; there is no consumer-centric or minimal-parent-involvement framing; rather the opposite appears. Why this rating: The school explicitly frames parents as co-teachers and emphasizes formation and partnership with families, aligning with CLASSICAL in this category.

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL elements

- The school scores CLASSICAL in Categories 1 (Religious Foundations), 2 (Purpose/Goal), and 6 (Parents & Community); SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL in Element 3 (Curriculum) and Element 5 (Faculty);

and NOT CLASSICAL in Element 4 (Pedagogy). Taken together, the overall portrait is CLASSICAL, with notable classical affinities tempered by gaps in publicly stated curricular specifics and pedagogy methods.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 3 (Curriculum) to move toward CLASSICAL:
- Publicly articulate explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framework (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Great Books and primary-source engagement, and the Great Conversation in published curricular language.
- Include explicit references to history as a throughline across disciplines, rather than “social studies” framing, and emphasize the canon of Western civilization in public materials.
- For Element 4 (Pedagogy) to move toward CLASSICAL:
- Publicly state explicit pedagogical methods consistent with classical education (Socratic seminars, memory work/recitation, scholé/restful learning cycles, and opportunities for high-school rhetoric and oratory). Include evidence of lower-school singing/chanting and memory work as part of a contemplative pedagogy, if applicable, but explicitly connect them to a classical pedagogy framework.
- For Element 5 (Faculty) to move toward CLASSICAL:
- Publish a formal “Living Curriculum” statement and a concrete portrait of the teacher as exemplar in classical formation; detail professional development in classical pedagogy and how faculty model virtue and wisdom as part of the curriculum.
- For Element 6 (Parents & Community) to stay strong or move toward CLASSICAL:
- Maintain and expand explicit parent-education initiatives (book clubs, lectures, seminars) on classical education and paideia, and make visits and family-engagement events more visible in public pages.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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